

Delaware County Budget Hearings October 16th 2024

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=VmaeZG_X7mo
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Target Category	delaware_county

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Municipal Meeting Report: Delaware County Council Budget Hearing

1. Pre-Hearing & Committee Work Sessions

(This section is omitted as the meeting commenced directly with budget review discussions.)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** 00:00:38 The presiding officer called the meeting to order, identifying it as a budget hearing session of the Delaware County Council.
- **Attendance:**
 - *Members Present:* Council members (including identified references to Bill, Matt, and Carrie) and staff/financial officers (including Elizabeth).
 - *Members Absent:* Not explicitly detailed in the transcript.
 - *Presiding Officer:* Unnamed Council President / presiding chair.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Not present in the transcript.
 - **Approval of Minutes:** Not present in the transcript.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:01:00 Budget Adjustments: FICA, PERF, and Prosecutor Longevity**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Elizabeth and finance staff.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Staff reviewed updated figures for FICA (recalculated to \$1,424,231) and PERF (recalculated to \$1,178,000). Adjustments were made to family support line items and prosecutor longevity pay schedules, incorporating a tiered experience matrix approach confirmed via email from Eric.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Reviewed for inclusion in upcoming appropriation ordinances.
- **00:05:31 Highway, Bridge, and MVH Fund Corrections**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Carrie (presenting corrections to Matt's spreadsheet).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The council reviewed line-item corrections in the engineering, bridge, and Motor Vehicle Highway (MVH) funds. Adjustments included correcting base salaries for operators and laborers (moving figures back to base without longevity add-ins), verifying garage and highway foreman splits, and finalizing totals.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Incorporated into draft budget figures.
- **00:18:27 Revenue Projections and Inmate Fees**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Finance staff and council members.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion centered on revenue line items, specifically adjusting inmate fee revenue estimates upward from \$700,000 to \$1.2 million based on current year collections hitting the \$1 million mark. The council reviewed estimated ending cash operating balances for 2025.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Accepted into revenue projections.
- **00:29:14 Planning Commission Give-Back Wish List**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Colleen Swackhamer (Planning Commission).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Swackhamer presented options for utilizing unused principal planner salary funds (\$119,500 remaining) for office purchases rather than returning all funds immediately. Proposed items included two digital cameras (\$350 total), a conference room table (\$2,400), conference room chairs (\$5,400,

contingent on court chair hand-me-downs), an iPad (\$1,000), and a black-and-white copier (\$3,995).

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** Colleen Swackhamer spoke regarding department needs and historical salary return figures (\$85,000 returned over the past three years).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Agreed to structure the Planning Commission give-back at \$18,200 (excluding chair purchases, as old court chairs will be repurposed).
 - **00:38:00 Departmental Give-Backs & Reductions**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council members and department heads.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The council tallied give-backs across various departments to finalize operating balances. Figures included: Prosecutor's office (\$30,000), Courts (\$5,000 out of transcription fees, \$15,000 professional services, \$10,000 other services), EMS (\$4,600), Sheriff (\$20,000), and Sheriff LIT (\$19,500).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Compiled into the overall budget give-back tally.
 - **00:51:55 General Fund Salary and Line-Item Adjustments**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Bill (Council Member) and Council.
 - **Deliberation Summary:**
 - *Commissioner Salaries (Line 101):* Proposed keeping commissioner salaries frozen at their current level rather than increasing them, resulting in a savings of \$4,030. Approved by consensus.
 - *County Attorney Base Salary:* Kept at \$31,965 (Line 106), resulting in a savings of \$1,278. Approved by consensus.
 - *Master Commissioner Salary:* Adjusted to align with deputy prosecutors, setting the split lines at \$47,500 each (\$95,000 total base) with an adjustment cost of \$1,878. Approved by consensus.
 - *Vehicle Purchases:* Discussion on cutting vehicle line items to zero and reconsidering via additional appropriations in April/May if inmate fee revenues trend high. The item was held for further review.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Consensus adjustments noted for final budget preparation.
 - **00:06:54 Local Income Tax (LIT) Review**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Finance staff and council.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The council reviewed LIT totals, revenue estimates, and beginning balances to ensure alignment with statutory requirements before gateway submission.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Reviewed; pivot tables and summary sheets to be finalized for Tuesday.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

(No general public comment period or citizen forum was held during this working session.)

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Staff will update FICA and PERF figures, distribute finalized pivot tables, and draft the required give-back resolution for the Department of Local Government Finance (DLGF) / Gateway submission.
 - Notice given regarding impending compliance work to match job titles, descriptions, FLSA status, and salary rates with HR records ahead of January 1 payroll.
 - **Adjournment:** 01:17:10 The meeting recessed until Tuesday morning at 9:00 AM for the official budget adoption meeting, to be followed by the regular County Council meeting.
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